ZNEXORA TECH | SECURITY BRIEFING

Web Defacement Awareness



Protecting our website, our reputation and our visitors.

Presented by: **ZNexora Tech** · [Presenter] · [Date]

What is web defacement?

An attack where someone gains access to a website and changes what visitors see.

Pages may be replaced with **messages, images or political slogans**, or quietly altered with **fake links and hidden code**.

It is the **visible symptom** of a security breach.



Why web defacement matters



Reputation and trust

Customers and partners lose confidence in our security.



Service disruption

The site may need to go offline while we investigate and recover.



A deeper breach

Attackers may also have stolen data or planted malware.



Legal exposure

Possible regulatory reporting duties if personal data is affected.

Who defaces websites, and why



Hacktivists

Spread political or social messages to a wide audience.



Opportunists

Scan the internet for easy targets, often for bragging rights.



Cybercriminals

Hide malware, scam pages or spam links on trusted sites.

Most attacks are **automated and opportunistic**: no website is too small to be a target.

How attackers get in

Outdated CMS and plug-ins

Known flaws in WordPress, themes or plug-ins left unpatched.

Weak or stolen passwords

Admin logins guessed, reused, or phished from staff.

Injection flaws

Insecure forms or code let attackers run commands.

Insecure file uploads

Malicious files uploaded through forms or media tools.

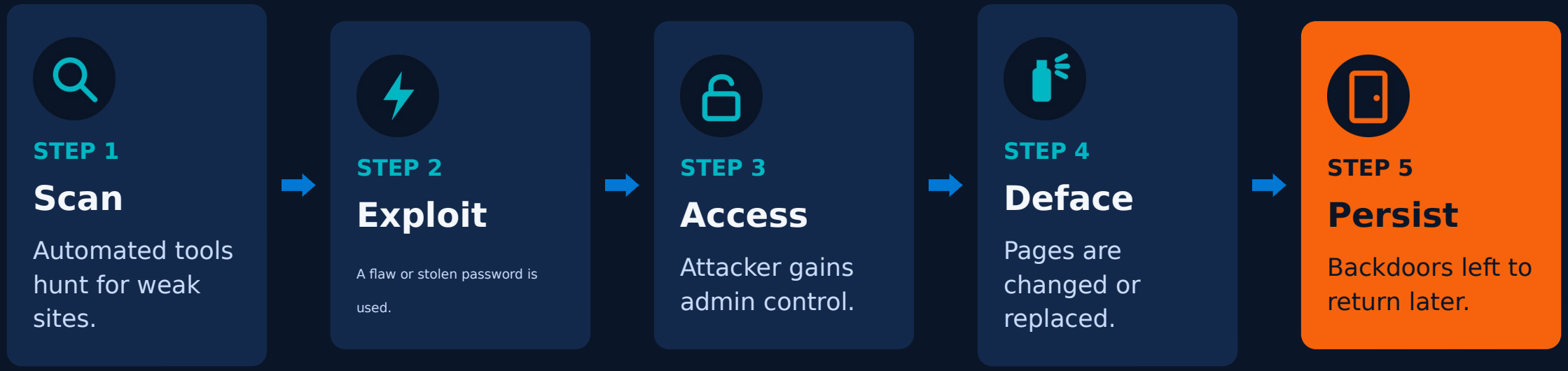
Misconfigured servers

Default settings, open admin panels, loose permissions.

Third parties

Compromised hosting, DNS accounts or web agencies.

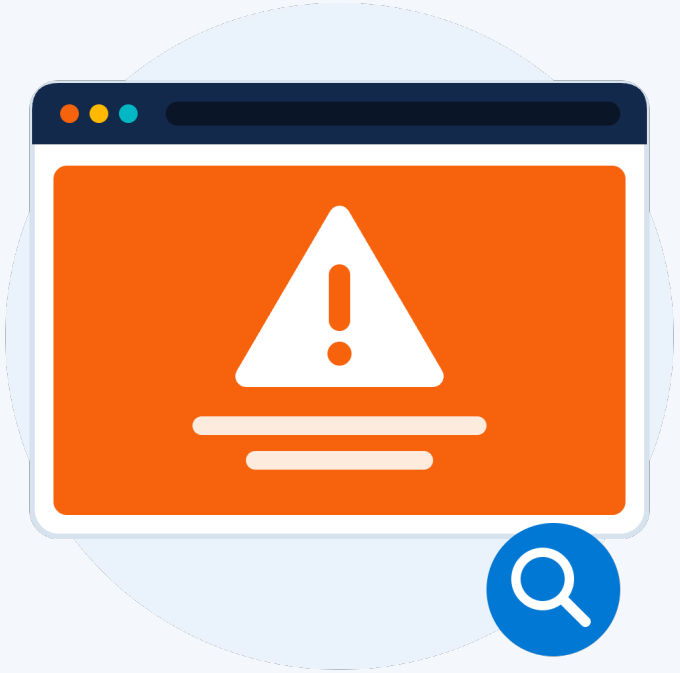
How a defacement attack unfolds



Restoring the page is not enough: **find and close the way in**, or they will be back.

Warning signs of a defacement

- Pages, images or text **changed without approval**
- **Unknown pages**, pop-ups or redirects to other sites
- Browser or search engine **security warnings**
- **New admin accounts** or unexpected file changes
- **Visitors or customers** reporting something odd



IF YOU SEE IT

Capture it.
Report it.
Don't touch it.

Fast reporting limits the damage.



Responding to a defacement

EVERYONE

1. **Report immediately** to [IT / Security contact]
2. **Capture evidence:** screenshot, web address and time
3. **Don't edit, delete or share** the defaced content

WEB AND IT TEAM

4. **Isolate:** switch to a maintenance page
5. **Fix the cause:** patch, remove backdoors, reset passwords
6. **Restore** from a clean backup; Comms team informs users



Six controls that prevent defacement

Patch quickly

CMS, plug-ins, themes and servers.

MFA everywhere

Website, hosting, DNS and domain logins.

Least privilege

Only the access each person needs.

Web application firewall

Blocks common attacks before they land.

Monitor changes

File integrity and uptime alerts.

Tested backups

Offline copies we can restore fast.

Everyone has a role

All staff

- Report anything odd on our website
- Never share website or hosting logins
- Watch for phishing aimed at admins

Content editors

- Use your own account, with MFA
- Install only approved plug-ins
- Log out on shared devices

Web and IT team

- Patch, monitor and review logs
- Remove unused accounts and plug-ins
- Test backups and the response plan

Who to contact

IT / Security

[Extension]

Report a suspected defacement

Web team

[web@...]

Unexpected changes or errors

Communications

[Contact]

All media and customer messages

Out of hours? Call **[on-call number]**. Every minute online increases the damage.

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

Our website is our front door.

Let's keep it secure, together.

Thank you · Presented by **ZNexora Tech**

